



AI Time Tracker

"Time" is a new AI-powered time tracking application that can help you stop procrastinating. Continue reading: <http://dgit.in/TimeAIApp>



Peeqo the GIF Robot

Peeqo is a robot that you can interact with and will mostly respond to you using smart GIFs. <http://dgit.in/PeeqoGIF>

saw a huge rise in the implementation of surveillance cameras around the world in law enforcement to traffic control and even legal proceedings in matters that involved adultery and parental negligence.

Digitisation improved the quality of video surveillance vastly. What earlier used to comprise of grainy, hard to interpret images was now clear, easy to identify footage. Police and investigative work especially benefited from the digital video surveillance implemented across cities, that even allowed the alteration of images for their purposes. Another advantage that digital video offered in the 1990s was after the advent of digital multiplexing that allowed the usage of multiple cameras at the same time in the same surveillance system. The one big change that happened over the years, especially in the 90s, was that people were no longer apprehensive of an unknown person watching over them in retail stores and public places. In fact, it made them feel safer. Needless to say, since the arrival of the internet, video surveillance has been mostly network based and the quality has only been limited by the camera itself.

The big brother sees all

Take any dystopian future in fiction from the recent past and you'll find watchtowers with searchlights, laser grids and electrified fences everywhere. While it's great that those dystopias were wrong, we've submitted ourselves to a totalitarianism of a different kind. Instead of being watched, we are voluntarily checking in with the powers that be. Conspicuous synchronization through swipe cards and IDs, automatic tolls and kiosks now dot our landscape with hundreds of points where we, within our senses, willingly give away our location and much more, often in exchange for goods and services.

Don't get us wrong. When viewed separately, you have every right to believe that each of those points and other digital interactions are innocuous. But, with each new camera,

MADE IN INDIA

If you thought that our own country wasn't really involved in surveillance – maybe because of technical backwardness in many government ventures – get ready to be surprised once again. Under the Indian Telegraph Act of 1885 (yeah, 132 years old), these are the mass surveillance programs operating in India –

- **Central Monitoring System Project (CMS)** - Recently labelled as one of the top 3 worst online spies
- **DRDO Netra** - Reportedly, the system can detect selective words like "bomb", "blast", "attack" or "kill" within seconds from emails, instant messages, status updates and tweets
- **Lawful Intercept And Monitoring Project (LIM)** - Used by the Indian Government to intercept records of voice, SMSs, GPRS data, details of a subscriber's application and recharge history and call detail record (CDR) and monitor Internet traffic, emails, web-browsing, Skype and any other Internet activity of Indian users
- **National Cyber Coordination Centre (NCCC)** - A proposed cyber security and e-surveillance project in India that could operate with limitless authority and without any legal framework.
- **Telecom Enforcement Resource and Monitoring Project (TERM)** - This is the vigilance and monitoring wing of the Department of Telecommunications.

barcode, database, registration and ID, a node is added in concert with a larger overall move towards total surveillance. And at the centre of it all lies the modern digital brain - a computer.

Nobody is claiming that every one of us is totally unaware of the eyes on our backs. But in 2013, Edward Snowden, a contractual worker at National Security Agency (NSA) in the US came forward with information that would change the world forever. A cache of documents that Snowden



Edward Snowden has become something of a symbol in the fight against mass surveillance

shared with certain media outlets revealed a global surveillance network that was beyond imagination. From phone calls to emails, location data to cable TV preferences, every single bit of information across several nations around the world was at the Agency's disposal thanks to several international treaties and agreements. And if you were looking at this as just a smear on the US Intelligence network, you would be wrong as even Australia and UK have accepted this as one of the worst blows to their intelligence networks in history.

If you think that there is no way the cameras and microphones in devices around you can be accessed over the internet by a diligent hacker, you couldn't be further away from the truth. Ethical issues aside, this can very well be done by government agencies with a reason behind them. Combine this with drones and minuscule electronics that are becoming harder to detect to the point of being pretty much undetectable, and voilà, you have the perfect cocktail of technology that monitors each and every move, or rather, a lack of it, in our cases anyway.

Well, at least, we're all a part of history now, eh? 